

Dear dr. Lotte Krabbenborg and professor Wouter Boon,

My name is Varvara Lazarenko, and I would like to express my interest in applying for a PhD position on Responsible Development of Digital Innovation in Mental Healthcare.

From the moment I discovered this position, I felt it aligned perfectly with my career aspirations to address the societal issues of the healthcare system. As a recent graduate of the Medical Biology master's program with a specialization in Science, Management & Innovation (SMI) from Radboud University, I am passionate about advancing healthcare in a more sustainable and cost-effective way, ultimately benefiting patients, medical professionals, innovators, and society overall. That is why a research project on responsible scaling of digital innovation in mental healthcare presents a great interest to me.

My academic background equips me with a solid foundation for this role. Having finished a bachelor's in Biology and a master's in Medical Biology, I gained extensive knowledge in the field and developed a critical understanding of various medical technologies and biomedical challenges. During the SMI track in the second year of my master's, I gained valuable insights into the sustainability goals, health economics, health technology assessment (HTA), and innovation management through courses such as Future of Health, Methods of Societal Research, Sustainable Innovation Management, and How Health Systems Work.

In addition to my academic qualifications, my professional experience will be an asset for this PhD position. As a Junior Research Assistant at the Faculty of Biology and an assistant at a Contract Research Organization, I gained substantial experience in writing academic papers, designing experiments, preparing clinical documentation, and analyzing different data. These roles deepened my understanding of the scientific landscape, as well as the healthcare and pharmaceutical industries. Besides, my master's thesis at HAN University of Applied Sciences provided me with valuable experience in both qualitative and quantitative methods of social science research. It focused on the added value of home telemonitoring technology among elderly, which was analyzed via the HTA framework presented onto the Quadruple aim. Moreover, it gave me experience of conducting some parts of the thesis in Dutch, which further fuelled me to actively learn the language. Furthermore, during my SMI track, I had the opportunity to work on real-world projects such as "HTA of a Medical Guidance App for International Students in the NL" and "A Shared Ownership Model of the Green Corridor." These experiences greatly enriched my understanding of stakeholder collaboration and honed my skills in presenting and engaging audiences effectively.

To sum up, I believe that my strong motivation for sustainability research within healthcare field, combined with my comprehensive education and diverse professional experiences, positions me as a strong candidate for the PhD position on Responsible Development of Digital Innovation in Mental Healthcare. I am confident that this opportunity will bring me closer to my final academic and career goals – towards the future of an expert in connecting science and society in a sustainable way.

Thank you for considering my application and, in case any questions arise, please do not hesitate to contact me.

Kind regards,
Varvara Lazarenko